

disease. On the other hand, there have been a good number of reports indicating no health risk at all.

It cannot, however, be denied that mobile phone radiation affects living cells. In October 2004, scientists at the Karolinska Institute in Stockholm gave a new warning about mobile phone radiation and brain tumours. They found that long term users of mobile phones were four times as likely to develop growths on the side they held the phone, and twice as likely as non-users to develop these benign, non-cancerous growths. They saw no increased risk from mobile phone radiation in those who had used mobile phones for less than 10 years. The study was of 150 mobile phone users, compared to 60 in a control group.

However, the effects on individual users may vary depending on the type of electromagnetic radiation. For instance, GSM and GPRS (2.5G) phones use pulsed radiation, where the levels rise and fall very rapidly. 3G phones on the other hand use continuous levels. Hence, studies show varied results because they may have analysed different types of radiation. Dr Kjell Hansson Mild in Sweden studied radiation risk in 11,000 mobile telephone users. Symptoms such as fatigue, headaches, and burning sensations on the skin were more common among those who made longer mobile phone calls. Evidence from human studies of mobile phone radiation indicates short-term raised blood pressure and mild direct brain warming.

In all, different studies have reached contradictory conclusions. There still persist real uncertainties about mobile phone radiation. The health risk to an individual user from electromagnetic radiation may be minor, but it's possible that some individuals may be more prone to the side effects of radiation than others.

Nevertheless, read the user manual of any mobile phone: the safety warnings will ask you to "switch off the phone when refuelling." Avoid using your phone near fuel or chemicals. Also, don't use your phone where there is blasting in progress, and also in a hospital or when you are close to any medical equipment.